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Loudoun County School Board, Student Behavior and Accountability Committee, Monday, April 22, 2024

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Place	Loudoun County Public Schools / School Board meeting (see BoardDocs / LCPS-TV)
Length	23m (video)

- Official meeting video (Vimeo / LCPS-TV): https://player.vimeo.com/video/938015004?rel=0
- BoardDocs (School Board): https://go.boarddocs.com/vsba/loudoun/Board.nsf/Public

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-21. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:00] Well, good evening, everyone. Thank you for your patience with all the technical problems. I'd like to call this meeting to order on my school phone. It says it's 629 p.m. And we're going to begin with the information item dealing with personal devices.

[00:00:24] So I have no agenda or nothing in front of me, so you'll have to help me along. Okay, we're good. Yes, that's the one that is policy 8655, student personal device use. Okay.

[00:00:42] Good? All right. So tonight we are bringing here for the first reading a policy 8655, student personal device use. This policy expands on what is already included in policy 8650, which is student technology acceptable and responsible use policy.

[00:01:00] So the goal of this policy is to clarify expectations around personal device use for students in schools. It was a policy that we've developed across multiple input. We've gathered feedback from students, gathered feedback from teachers, gathered feedback from principals.

[00:01:19] Many central office staff have also reviewed this, so it's been a real team effort. So thanks to everyone who helped out putting this together. So this is the first reading. So it'll go out for feedback tomorrow via the standard process. So it'll be posted in Let's Talk, and we'll be able to collect that feedback and bring that back at the May meeting.

[00:01:37] So walking through the policy, we did work with other school districts. So we surveyed Fairfax, Prince William, just different districts and how they're managing their student cell phone policy or student personal device usage.

[00:01:54] It is also interesting, the state will potentially have a model policy, but we don't believe that we'll have it in time in order for us to have something in place with the goal of having something in place before the start of the school year, so that if we're going to have something, we can bring that to the June school board meeting, and then it'll be ready to go in August when our students return.

[00:02:12] So walking through the policy, since it's a brand new policy, it's all red line. So we walk through the policy. The first part really just covers section student personal device use. Section 1 just means that they need to comply with SR&R and other policies and not do anything to subvert our network securities and our network protocols.

[00:02:37] Number 2 walks through that student technology devices may only be used in designated locations and at designated times. We will still have teachers the option in different grade levels, and so the policy was written to have flexibility where cell phones and other personal device types can have instructional benefits, but really limited to it's off and less explicitly allowed versus the way it is now. It's up to teachers to kind of manage it, and that's one of the things I think we heard loud and clear with our feedback. Students and teachers may not agree on what the policy should say, but they

[00:03:15] definitely agree that it needs to be consistent, and there needs to be a consistent set of expectations so that's hopefully that we can set a cell phones are often away unless explicitly allowed and then we have some working with different levels elementary school students not permitted to not permitted to use we provide a chromebook for every single student grades pre-k through 12 and that should be the device that they use most of the time in school middle school must keep their devices off and away most middle schools are already implemented this across the district So this just codifies practices that are already in place.

[00:03:49] And then high school students may have personal technology devices on their person and must ensure the devices are silenced during instructional time. Probably the majority of high schools are doing this at this point. This would establish a consistent practice across all high schools for all students.

[00:04:05] Then there is Section 3 walks through what is prohibited. No photography, audio, video recording in bathrooms, locker rooms, or clinics. We got a lot of this language from Fairfax's policy when they rolled this out. Inappropriate use of social media images and text messages is not allowed.

[00:04:23] Cyberbullying is not allowed or tolerated. Again, referencing the SRNR and the SPS Student Code of Conduct. Moving on to Section B, school leadership should clearly communicate expectations to staff, students, and families at the beginning of school about what the expectations are when they are allowed.

[00:04:42] Say, if there are allowances for at lunchtime or something like that, they should be very explicit with when they are allowed at their school. So there's still some flexibility in here for school by school. And then teachers may allow. We do have some specific educational activities.

[00:05:01] Pictures for art, for example, where cell phones really are better than using a Chromebook-type camera to take those type of images. Section C are the student and parent-guardian responsibilities.

Parents should avoid contacting their children via personal devices during the school day unless there's an emergency.

[00:05:18] We get a lot of notices back and forth or check-ins, and that's really some of the disruptions that we see in school. And the student is solely responsible for the item, so if they do bring something to school, we're not responsible for those devices. And then Section D is the exceptions list.

[00:05:34] So this is basically if you need to have some sort of device on your person, whether that's an IEP, a 504, a medical reason, that those would be still allowed, and they would just need to be documented by the school so they would know that. These would be things like diabetes monitors that connect via Bluetooth to someone's smartphone where they still need to have that on their person.

[00:05:55] Yes. That's what I was hoping to hear as you were going through this. So that is really the summary of the policy. Again, it'll be put for public feedback tomorrow, as long as we got the thumbs up here. We, again, cross-referenced any student discipline, any bullying prevention.

[00:06:15] Those are in the student acceptable use policy are already policies, so we didn't really want to embed things like disciplinary practices in this. They should still follow those other, just as if there was another disruption or another student not following direction, those other policies would come into play at that point. So with that, I think the last thing that I just wanted to mention is we get a lot of requests sometimes to block cell phones or to make sure that they don't work, and that's actually against FCC regulation where we're not allowed to do that.

[00:06:43] So it actually specifically says on the FCC site, specifically states there are no exceptions for use within a business, classroom, residence, or vehicle, so it's pretty clear that we are not to do that. So really it comes down to a student behavior in classroom management at that point, And so that's where we hope this policy will help at least set some clear guidance for teachers.

[00:07:07] And with that, I'm happy to take any questions. Carrie, I have a question. There's no indication here that teachers and staff, about teachers and staff use of cell phones, do they not have any interference with instruction when teachers and staff are on their phones during the instruction a day?

[00:07:42] So this policy specifically is targeted towards student personal device usage. So we do even have separate acceptable use policies for staff and for students. So right now we're focused on the students, but that's one of the conversations we have with schools. It's important to model appropriate behavior.

[00:07:59] And schools that do block cell phone usage, they do end up having conversations with staff about what appropriate use looks like. It's, I think, a little bit more difficult with staff to have a policy. We have a lot of things like, for example, Raptor app on personal phones to do things like emergencies and notifications.

[00:08:19] And so having an off and away for staff really isn't feasible in that world. So I think it really comes down to really stressing with schools the need to model appropriate behavior for students. Okay. What about the smart watches? I know one of the things that my husband and I talk about, Boy, if I had had a cell phone with Google or a smartwatch with Google when I was in school, that would have set me on top of the world.

[00:08:49] I've been an A student. So this policy is intended to cover all of those. That includes AirPods, earbuds, smartwatches, personal gaming devices, cell phones.

[00:09:05] So really any sort of technology would follow the same rules. It is, when it becomes a disruption to the classroom, they're having clear expectations. So that's the goal of this policy is I think that's part of the reason it took us a while to get here is because there was a lot of conversations that went into this about what's appropriate.

[00:09:25] And so that's really where this policy came out of is probably about a year worth of conversations with that. But you don't see where students could access answers to assessments by way of their cell phone or smart watches?

[00:09:44] Oh, absolutely, but they can cheat with or without that device there, so it still is about appropriate behavior is what it comes down to, and that's what makes it so difficult is it really is an appropriate student behavior and a classroom management, and like I said, there's nothing we can do to, like, block them or physically remove them.

[00:10:03] So we are, hopefully this takes a step in the direction to help teachers in the classroom to help manage that. Okay, I don't have any other questions. Carrie, I don't have any other questions. I have a question.

[00:10:21] Go ahead, Dr. Ashid. Okay. Thank you for putting this together. I just was just a little curious about any mention of transportation, so use of electronics in transportation.

[00:10:37] I'm assuming because it doesn't interfere with instruction. That's why that wasn't mentioned in this draft. There is one reference to inappropriate use is included, So if you do something inappropriate, you would still be, I think it's section A, number four, that that also includes LCBS transportation.

[00:10:59] So if you are engaged in cyberbullying and that's occurring on a school bus, that would still be covered by this policy. But no, there's no specific language in here that would say, do not use your devices when you're on LCBS transportation. Okay, thank you.

[00:11:15] And then another thing was, I think you and I had this discussion a while back. I was told there was like a Wi-Fi blocker in some schools, or I don't know if that was true. If, let's say, their devices are using, well, if there is a Wi-Fi blocker, can they use the satellite that's there in these buildings?

[00:11:38] Like the regular, for example, AT&T or brand or company named satellite usage for this? Correct. So we don't block any access. So we have an LCBS open network, and specifically that's the only network these devices are allowed to connect to. It would be 99% of internal school buildings would be covered with that wireless network.

[00:11:59] That doesn't impede, say, dropping off onto your LTE, like your Verizon or your AT&T cellular service. So we don't have anything in place that's impeding either one of those. Not that schools have deployed or not that DDI has deployed.

[00:12:16] Okay. And I read somewhere here that it said it's prohibited in the bathrooms, in the lockers, or in the clinics. So I was just wondering if there was any, let's say, specificity. I mean, I know we can't take things away from students. This is their belongings.

[00:12:35] But the worry I have is if it's taken lightly and like, you know, there's always some students that'll go in the bathroom or go in the locker room and, you know, use their video and then post and it

becomes like a sense of bullying and stuff like that.

[00:12:51] So that's my main concern. Again, I'm just thinking out loud and I'm just reading, I think, item number three. And that's where it says it's prohibited in the bathrooms, locker rooms or clinics. but um i don't know if you could give some suggestions in terms of verbiage that could make it a little bit more i don't know tighter or more stricter in that sense um but then again i know that we have our limits in what we can do with our devices so when it says prohibited if that should be a violation that's where it goes into like a disciplinary practices would come

[00:13:25] into play so it's still going to be up to school administrators following disciplinary practices when rules are broken, it's not just cell phone students break lots of rules and do things. And so even a lot of the, we don't see a lot of tech discipline because of a technical thing they're doing. We see a lot of discipline because they don't put it away or they don't follow direction from teachers. So that's what we actually see a lot of the technology is that the discipline is for not following directions, not that the technology is actually the disruption.

[00:13:57] Thank you. Thank you so much. One more question. Who's going to be monitoring them in the bathrooms? that's a that's a it might be a rhetorical question because but that's um what i have a 13 year old that doesn't even want to go in the bathrooms because of what goes on in the bathrooms so so this policy covers lots of different areas so um those are things that we can take back and talk about with like department of school leadership or with some other avenues but we wouldn't be necessarily monitoring for this i think if there was a it was used inappropriately

[00:14:37] then this policy would allow for the disciplinary practices. So it's really, it's not allowed. I think it's the same way as like a speed limit sign. Like it says 55 and then you choose to go 70, then that's when the cop can pull you over. So that's similar to what this policy is because there's really nothing we can put in place to say block cell phone signals in bathrooms.

[00:14:58] There's just nothing like that. You gave a real world example, huh? 50 miles per hour versus 70. Thank you, thank you. Carrie, I don't think I have any more questions.

[00:15:17] Me neither. All righty. That being said, is there anything else that anybody wishes to add? Well, I forgot. I think, Carrie, you asked it or someone just asked a question about what is, and I didn't get the answer, what if there's someone that needs it for, like, a medical issue and they need the phone, like, every hour to check their, for example, the sugar levels?

[00:15:44] Mm-hmm. Go ahead and answer if you have the answer to that. Those would be similar to anything else. They would be recorded in this appropriate system, whether it was an IEP, a 504, or a medical need in the clinic. So they would be aware of those things, but it would have to be something the school knew about.

[00:16:04] And so I think that's where some schools are really going to need to know which students actually need these things and how that works. Since we don't have a policy in place right now, we may need to build some of that knowledge because I bet you every kid who's using a cell phone to monitor sugar levels is not, the school is not aware of every single one of them at this point.

[00:16:24] I know that we were talking about that through SEAC and the Student Services Department, and they're trying to gather a list of all of the students that would need that sort of thing.

[00:16:44] Certainly, it should be listed on every 504 and IEP, if that's the case. Every teacher is provided with a copy of the student's IEP or 504 plan. So it's just a matter of making sure that the teachers are aware that they have to look at that and that this child has the opportunity to use the personal device for medical needs or specific IEP or 504 needs.

[00:17:13] So that's where we're going with that one. I just have one question. It's off topic, but it's tied in with this. Are the classrooms, do they have panic buttons in them in case of emergency or there's a, God forbid, there's a shooter or something like that that enters a building?

[00:17:32] As I recall, when I was teaching, there was a button you could switch and it connected immediately to the front office. You could tell what you needed or what was going on. but if there was a shooter, they would announce, oh Lord, is it code blue? There's an announcement that tells you there's a shooter in the building or lockdown, and that's how you got that information, and you immediately shut down everything. The problem with that, that I found, is that when we were doing our emergency response plan with the students, or when there was a

[00:18:07] lockdown or a hold, all of a sudden every student had their phone out and was very busy texting home telling mom and that light can be seen from outside even with the uh paper blocking the window so that's something we're going to have to work on with students as well and erin i'm sorry thanks um thanks miss carrie um that's what i was saying erin i know i digressed but that i wanted to like wrap it in or bring it into that that if that's not good enough it was nice to have a phone just to kind of have a 911 or emergency call of some sort for the safety of the students and the staff and the teachers.

[00:18:46] So that's where my thoughts were, but thanks. So part of ongoing project for our unified communications, this is actually a CIP project included in that budget, is to install a unified communication system throughout every single building. So the first phase of that was to put a phone in every single classroom because we did not have 911 capability everywhere.

[00:19:04] So that has been completed and now every classroom has a communication device. At least one that is compliant with Carrie's law for 9-1-1 and location reporting and those type of things. So that's a baseline that's out there in every single instructional space.

[00:19:21] Thank you. Any other comments, questions? No, I have none. Okay. If so, do we want to thank you, Mr. Smith, and let you get on to your next meeting?

[00:19:39] Thank you very much. Like I said, this will be posted for public feedback starting tomorrow. So we do anticipate getting a lot of feedback on this policy. We'll bring all of that back in May. And then if we're trending in a good direction, then hopefully to the full board in the June time frame.

[00:19:55] So just a rough synopsis of the timeline and I look forward to, it'll be posted tomorrow and look forward to start getting that feedback. So thank you. Well, thank you for your patience. I appreciate that. So, all righty. What was the next one you wanted to go to?

[00:20:12] Linda? The next information item is a policy bit about rights of adult students, policy 8025. Yeah, I remember that one. I listened to a woman scream at me for over a half hour, so we'd all have to speak to that.

[00:20:38] Could I suggest that perhaps we go back and certify the March minutes because we don't want to lose sight of that, and that shouldn't take very long? Okay. All right. As far as minutes go, have you all

had an opportunity to read them?

[00:20:57] Yes. Yes. Is there anything you see that is inaccurate or needs to be changed? No. Then may I have a motion to accept the minutes as presented? I motion to accept the minutes as presented.

[00:21:15] Is there a second? And I second that motion. And the motions and the minutes are approved. Okay? Okay. All right. So do you want to look at student speech and expression? Well, I think that at this point, we don't have the time to look at them because Dr. Rasheed has another meeting as well.

[00:21:43] So I'm wondering if I could make a motion to move all the other agenda items to our next meeting. I second your motion. Is that a motion? yes it is my motion to move all the other agenda items to our next meeting is there a second i second all in favor say aye aye aye all opposed seeing none a motion passed so our next meeting

[00:22:22] is barna when is our next meeting may 20th okay may 20th yes and it will be the first of our meetings that will convene at 4 30 instead of six all right well thank you um with that all said the meeting is adjourned

